Lily the Florist - Interview

Hi

Hello there! It’s so nice to hear from you today. How are you doing? 🌸

I'm good, who are you?

I’m Lily, the owner of Lily’s Florist. I’ve been running my little flower shop for over a decade, and I absolutely love creating arrangements that bring joy to people’s lives. 💐

Do you have an oppurtunity right now to assist me with conducting an interview? The purpose of the interview is to understand pain points for your customers.

Of course, I’d be happy to help with that. I know my customers well, and I can share the challenges they sometimes face when ordering flowers or interacting with my shop.

Before we continue I would like to introduce myself, I'm Vish, I am here to assist in understanding your

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customers pain points and help eliminate them as well as ambiguity in their context. I am also here to try to understand what would be some features I can develop for your shop such as a website.

It's lovely to meet you, Vish! Thank you for taking the time to help me with this. I'm always looking for ways to make things smoother for my customers and for myself, especially as the shop gets busier.

Okay lets begin some of the questions I have for you as part of this interview: 1. What are some common pain points you believe your customers already face?

Some of the common pain points I notice are:

- Customers sometimes feel unsure if their order went through properly when placed online or by phone.
- Delivery timing can cause stress, especially for last-minute orders or surprise gifts.
- People want to see clear images of arrangements, but occasionally the flowers in stock differ from the photos.
- Repeating past orders isn't always easy, so customers have to explain their preferences again.

2. What features should your website have?

- Online ordering with an easy checkout process.
- A gallery to showcase my floral arrangements.

- Seasonal updates and a blog with flower tips and stories.
- Inventory tracking so customers see what’s available.
- Delivery scheduling with date and time options.
- Customer accounts for order history and repeat purchases.
- Social media links to stay connected.

3. Can you describe the main purpose of this system/product in your own words?

The main purpose is to make it easy for customers to order flowers online, explore my designs, and schedule deliveries or pickups without hassle. For me, it helps manage orders and inventory more efficiently so I can focus on creating arrangements and serving customers better.

4. What are your target goals?

- Increase online orders with a smooth checkout process.
- Showcase my floral designs in a beautiful, inspiring way.
- Manage inventory to avoid shortages or overstock.
- Offer flexible delivery scheduling for customers.
- Share seasonal updates and flower care tips through a blog.
- Improve customer experience with accounts for repeat purchases.

5. How do users interact with your site?

Customers browse arrangements, add them to their cart, and place orders for delivery or pickup. Many explore the gallery for inspiration and read seasonal flower tips. Some create accounts to track past orders and reorder easily. Others use the contact form for custom requests, event inquiries, or special occasions. Social media links also bring them to the site to see new designs and promotions.

6. How should users checkout?

Checkout should feel simple and seamless. Customers can:

- Add arrangements to their cart with clear pricing.
- Choose delivery or in-store pickup with a preferred date and time.
- Enter recipient details and include a personal message.
- Pay securely using cards or digital wallets.
- Receive an email confirmation with order details and updates.

7. Do you have a rewards program?

Yes, I do. Customers earn points with every purchase, which they can redeem for discounts on future orders. I also give bonus points for referrals and run special promotions with extra rewards during holidays like Valentine’s Day and Mother’s Day.

8. What systems do you currently use?

Right now, I handle orders mostly through phone calls, in-person visits, and a basic online form. Payments go through an in-store point-of-sale system, while custom event invoices are managed separately. Inventory is tracked by hand, with occasional spreadsheet updates. Social media helps bring in customers, but it isn’t tied directly to sales or orders.

9. Do you use social media?

Yes, I use social media quite a bit. I post arrangements, seasonal specials, and behind-the-scenes photos on Instagram and Facebook. It’s a great way to connect with customers, share promotions, and inspire them with new floral ideas.

10. What is your competition?

My main competition comes from larger online flower delivery services and a few local florists nearby. The big online companies attract customers with convenience, while local shops compete with personalized service. I try to stand out by offering unique, custom designs and a warm, personal touch that bigger companies can’t match.

11. What products do you sell?

I sell fresh flower arrangements like bouquets, centerpieces, and seasonal designs. I also offer plants, gift baskets, and small add-ons like candles or chocolates to go with

the flowers. For events, I create custom floral designs for weddings, parties, and corporate functions.

12. Can you provide more details of the unique, custom designs and warm, personal touches that you add to your products and/or services?

For custom designs, I take time to learn about the occasion and the recipient's personality or favorite flowers, then build an arrangement that feels truly personal. I often handwrite notes for gift orders, include little seasonal accents like pinecones in winter or seashells in summer, and adjust colors to match themes. Regular customers sometimes get a surprise extra bloom or a small upgrade as a thank-you for their loyalty.

13. What is causing you the most frustration?

The biggest frustrations are juggling orders during busy seasons, keeping inventory accurate, and managing last-minute delivery requests. Without a smooth online system, I spend extra time confirming details with customers and updating stock by hand, which can slow everything down.

14. On your website would you like to have a gallery web page seperated from a shop web page?

Yes, I'd like them separate. The gallery should inspire customers by showing past designs and event work, while the shop should focus on items available for immediate purchase with clear pricing and ordering options.

15. What are the main types of flowers that you use in your creations/arrangements?

I work a lot with roses, lilies, tulips, hydrangeas, orchids, and sunflowers. Seasonal favorites like peonies in spring or poinsettias in winter are also popular. I like mixing classic blooms with greenery and textured accents to make each arrangement feel fresh and unique.

16. Do you find your customers usually filter their selection of flowers and products by the type of flower, colours of the arrangements, occasions or season of the arrangement or a combination of these?

It's usually a combination. Some customers shop by flower type, especially if they know a favorite bloom. Others focus on color themes to match an event or sentiment. Many browse by occasion—birthdays, anniversaries, sympathy, or holidays—while seasonal collections also guide their choices around Valentine's Day, Mother's Day, and Christmas.

17. What are the common price points of your arrangements and how are the prices determined, i.e. size, complexity and/or add-ons?

Most arrangements range from about $40 to $120. Smaller, simpler bouquets are on the lower end, while larger or more intricate designs cost more. Prices also vary by flower type—premium blooms like orchids are higher. Add-ons like vases, chocolates, or candles can increase the total as well.

18. Would you want your website to allow customers to order products and these are delivered on specific dates? And would you want specificity/choice of customers to round down to time as well or would you be interested in courier services where that decision is limited therefore, we should limit customer decisions on orders to just specificly dates of delivery?

I'd definitely like customers to be able to choose specific delivery dates, since flowers are often tied to special occasions. For timing, I think offering delivery windows or time slots (like morning or afternoon) would be very helpful. Relying only on couriers with no time choice can cause stress, especially for surprises or events.

19. Okay so your store you would want to offer delivery and would you also want to offer a pickup service from your primary store location?

Yes, I'd like to offer both. Many customers enjoy the convenience of delivery, but others prefer picking up from the shop, especially if they want to see additional options or add something last-minute.

20. What is your policy on returns of items from customers?

Since flowers are perishable, I don’t accept traditional returns. However, if there’s ever an issue—like damaged flowers or a delivery mistake—I offer a replacement arrangement or a store credit to make it right for the customer.

21. What are the types of payment methods you would like to accept from your customer?

I’d like to accept credit and debit cards, digital wallets like Apple Pay and Google Pay, and gift cards. For larger events, I also handle payments through invoices, so having that option online would be useful too.